

STACKER PRIZE REDEMPTION

Complete Service & Restoration Guide for Public Placements

Mechanics • Optics • Free-Play Setup • Reliability

Prepared for **Coin Op 4 Charity** / Arcade Angels

Keeping prize-stacking redemption games reliable and fair for youth and community spaces

1. Overview & Goals

Stacker-style prize redemption machines challenge the player to stop a moving light or block at the right moment to build a stack and win a prize. They are popular in family entertainment centers and work well in youth centers when maintained for fairness and reliability. For charity and community placements the priorities are smooth mechanics, accurate sensors, clean presentation, and simple free-play or low-cost operation.

2. Safety

- Unplug the machine before any internal work.
- Moving mechanisms (motors, belts, prize delivery) can pinch — keep hands clear when testing under power.
- Prize doors and hoppers should be secured so they cannot be forced open by players.
- Keep the interior free of loose tools or parts before returning the machine to public use.

3. Cabinet Exterior & Presentation

- Clean the entire exterior thoroughly. Remove sticky residue, fingerprints, and dust from glass, side art, and the control area.
- Inspect graphics, decals, and the prize display window. Replace or carefully restore heavily damaged sections so the machine looks inviting.
- Confirm the prize display area is well-lit and the prizes are presented neatly — appearance strongly affects perceived value and fairness.
- Level the cabinet so mechanisms track straight and the machine does not rock.

4. Play Mechanism — Lights, Sensors & Timing

Accurate stopping of the moving light/block is the core of the game.

- Clean the playfield glass and any optical sensors thoroughly. Dust or haze causes missed or false stops.
- Inspect the moving light bar, LED array, or block carriage for smooth travel. Lubricate guide rails sparingly with appropriate plastic-safe lubricant if binding occurs.
- Confirm the stop button registers cleanly and the software/hardware responds immediately.
- Test the win detection (height sensors, optical sensors, or limit switches) so successful stacks are credited reliably and unsuccessful ones are not false-credited.

5. Prize Delivery System

- Inspect the prize hopper, dispenser, or door mechanism. Clean out debris and confirm free movement.
- Test that a win correctly triggers prize delivery and that the door or chute resets properly afterward.
- Check for jammed or misaligned prizes that could cause a delivery failure or an unfair “empty” win.
- For public placements, keep the prize selection age-appropriate and clearly displayed.

6. Power, Board & Connections

- Clean the power supply area and verify stable voltages under load.
- Reseat the main board and any sensor or motor driver boards. Clean connectors.
- Inspect motor wiring and limit-switch harnesses for damage or loose pins.
- Dust the interior thoroughly — heat and dust are the main long-term reliability issues.

7. Free-Play / Charity Configuration

Many Stacker machines can be set to free-play or very low cost via the operator menu or DIP switches. For youth-center and charity use:

- Enter the operator/setup menu (method varies by manufacturer — often a key switch or button combination inside the coin door).
- Set coin/credit requirements to free-play or the lowest practical setting approved by the host site.
- Document the exact settings used so future volunteers can restore or adjust them consistently.
- If the machine has a ticket or prize meter, clear or note the counts after testing.

8. Final Testing Checklist Before Placement

- Full cold boot to attract mode with lights and sound working
- Moving light/block travels smoothly and stops cleanly on button press
- Win detection correctly awards a successful stack and rejects a failed one
- Prize delivery functions and resets properly
- No binding, unusual noise, or intermittent sensor failures during repeated plays
- Cabinet exterior is clean, level, and free of sharp edges or loose parts
- Prize display is neat and age-appropriate
- Free-play or pricing configured correctly and documented for the host site
- Keys, spare fuses, and a short instruction sheet bagged and labeled for the host organization

9. Notes for Host Sites

Provide a short one-page sheet: power on/off, free-play status, and who to contact. Recommend a weekly wipe-down of the glass, button, and prize window. Ask the host to report any new sticking, missed wins, or prize jams early. Document the manufacturer/model if known and any non-original parts or settings for future volunteers.

This guide is intended for educational and nonprofit service use by Coin Op 4 Charity and partner organizations. The goal is a Stacker that stays fair, reliable, and fun for the people who play it.

Document version 1.0 • Coin Op 4 Charity / Arcade Angels • coinop4charity.org